sionately: to him, saving the name of the Jews is essential, since it has to do with his own conceptual and active determination" (p. 170). This "saving" gesture involves detaching the "Jews" from their Jewish identity because all identity (but especially Jewish identity) is inherently fascistic. In Badiou's view, Hitler has won if the "Jews" conceive of themselves in racial or ethnic or even, it seems, religious terms. For Badiou, "Jewishness" evidently has no meaning prior to fascism and no meaning beyond it. First and foremost, however, Badiou proposes to save the Jews by making them realize that the state of Israel is not a "Jewish" state, but is rather "the principal threat to the name of Jews comes from a state calling itself Jewish" (p. 169). Israel, once again, is guilty of the crime of "hostility to wandering, to minorities, to the universal, to revolutions" (p. 170). But as Badiou points out, these are the crimes of which all states are guilty. In this sense, all states are antisemitic, according to Badiou, because the "Jew" represents not only the obstacle to universalism but also the universal victim, the very symbol of what is oppressed by identity politics, by borders, by nations. (One thinks of the battle cry of May '68, "We are all German Jews.") Badiou's goal here, as throughout his work, is to oppose the bad, particularist incarnation of the "Jew" to the good, universalist one—the incarnation that makes the Jews a metaphor for victimhood and which involves rejecting actual Jews, or at least those who have not disavowed their affiliation with Judaism and the Jewish state.

Now there are many ways to critique this reappropriation of the language of universalism by the radical left. One can show its underlying hypocrisy, its fallacious logic, its ideological affinities with more blatant forms of antisemitism—and I have tried to point in all those directions. However, I want to add another dimension by showing that the rigid opposition between the universal and the particular espoused by Badiou and his followers is predicated on a misunderstanding of universalism both in Saint Paul and in French political history. With regard to Paul, I will rely on one of Badiou's most eloquent opponents, Eric Marty, a French literature scholar whose work is only now beginning to be translated into English.

In *Bref Séjour à Jerusalem* [Brief Stay in Jerusalem (2003)], Marty asks why French intellectuals have taken the lead in denouncing Israel as a racist, imperialist state. The answer, according to Marty, lies in the clash between two types of universalism, or rather, in the inability of French universalists like Badiou to understand other forms of universalism—especially the Jewish form. How, Badiou and his followers ask, can there be a universal belonging to a single people? This seems like a contradiction in terms. Does not the notion of Jewish election preclude the universal by binding salvation to a

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